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National Archives for Developers

The National Archives promotes the innovative application of agency data in public and private sectors. This page connects citizen developers with the tool they need to unlock government data.

Have suggestions, ideas, or questions? Please contact us at developer@nara.gov.

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GitHub

- **[The National Archives on GitHub](#)**

Makes code projects, policies, and plans related to the work of the U.S. National Archives available for public reuse, contribution, and comment.

- **[The Federal Register on GitHub](#)**

Makes available code related to the work of the Federal Register. For more about resources available on the Federal Register developer hub, see [Register developer hub](#).

- **[Plans and Strategies](#)**

GitHub enables NARA to make our plans and strategies available for public reuse, contribution, and comment.



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“Discuss” link in the top right corner of each page to provide your feedback on the following plans and strategies:

- [Open Government Plan 2016-2018](#)
- [Social Media Strategy 2017-2020](#)

Contributing

We welcome your feedback and suggestions on any of our GitHub repositories. If you'd like to contribute you can participate in one of three ways:

1. In GitHub: Discuss content via a repository's issues page. You can browse and participate in existing discussions or open a new issue to start a new conversation. Before submitting a new issue, please check to make sure a similar issue isn't already open. If one is, please contribute to that issue thread with your feedback. If you don't have a GitHub account, you can [get started here](#). Read [more about GitHub's issues feature](#). If you'd like to make a direct content edit, you can [submit a pull request](#).
2. Via email: If you prefer not to set up a GitHub account, we also welcome your input at developer@nara.gov. The US National Archives GitHub team monitors this address and will add suggestions to this repo's issues page.

Contribution Policy

You are encouraged to share your comments, ideas, and concerns on any of our GitHub repositories. Please be aware of the following policies for the National Archives' GitHub account:

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- NARA will remove comments that contain abusive, vulgar, offensive, threatening or harassing language, personal attacks of any kind, or offensive terms that target specific individuals or groups.
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- Contributions may be treated as a federal record.
- The content of all contributions are visible to the public, thus submissions should not contain anything you would not broadcast to the general public.
- Your comments are welcome at any time. We process comments between 8:30 am and 5:30 pm Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays. We intend to process comments submitted at other times as soon as possible the next business day.
- Gratuitous links to sites are viewed as spam



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Application Programming Interfaces (APIs)

- **National Archives Catalog API**
The National Archives Catalog API is a read-write web API for the National Archives Catalog. This API can be used to perform fielded search of archival metadata, bulk export of metadata and digital media, and post contributions to records. The dataset includes archival descriptions, authorities, digital media, web pages, and public contributions (such as tags, transcriptions, and comments).
- **The Federal Register API**
FederalRegister.gov is a fully open source project. The source code for the main site is available on GitHub, and there are chef cookbooks for maintaining the servers, WordPress themes and configuration.
- **Executive Orders from 1994 to 2012**
The President of the United States manages the Executive branch of Government through



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orders. After the President signs an executive order, the White House sends it to the Office of Federal Register (OFR). The OFR numbers each order consecutively as part of a series, and publishes it in the daily Federal Register shortly after receipt. This data is available as an [interactive dataset](#) and [API](#) through Data.gov.

- **Digital Public Library of American (DPLA) API** [↗](#)

The Digital Public Library of America (DPLA) is a universal digital public library, providing a single online access point for digital collections containing America's cultural, historical and scientific heritage. The National Archives participates as a leading content provider and has contributed 1.9 million digital images to the DPLA, including our nation's founding documents, photos from the Documerica Photography Project of the 1970's, World War II posters, Mathew Brady Civil War photographs, and a wide variety of documents that define our human and civil rights. The DPLA API allows you to build applications and tools for enhanced learning and content discovery. More information available at: <http://dp.la/info/developers/> [↗](#)

- **Flickr API**

The National Archives has made more than 10,000 images of [records](#) available on Flickr. As a participating institution in the Commons on Flickr, the National Archives makes available images of documents, photographs, and other records with no known copy restrictions. These records can be accessed through the Flickr API.

Datasets

- **National Archives Catalog**

This dataset contains the archival descriptions and authority records from the National Archives Catalog, including the URLs for digital copies of records and data from citizen archivist contributions.

- **1950 Census**

This dataset includes the metadata index, the population schedule and other forms, the enumeration district maps, and the enumeration district descriptions for the 1950 Census records.

- **1940 Census**

This dataset contains the the metadata index, the population schedules, the enumeration district maps, and the enumeration district descriptions for the 1940 Census records.

- **Code of Federal Regulations**

This dataset contains the Code of Federal Regulations in XML format. The CFR is the codification of the permanent regulations of the Federal Government in the Federal Register.

- **Federal Register**

This dataset contains the daily Federal Register.



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The Federal Register is the official legal newspaper of the United States Government.

- **United States Government Manual**

The U.S. Government Manual is the official handbook of the U.S. Government and available in XML format.

- **Public Papers of the Presidents of the United States**

This is the official public Presidential writings, addresses, and remarks in XML format.

- **Executive Orders of the Presidents of the United States**

The dataset contains the official documents through which the President of the United States manages the operations of the Federal Government in CSV format, and also as a combined [interactive dataset](#), and [API](#).

- [More Datasets.](#)

Crowdsourcing Tools

- **Transcribr** [↗](#)

This Drupal distribution includes all modules and themes required to emulate the National Archives [Transcription Pilot Project](#), which allows the public to transcribe historical documents to make them more accessible to the public.

[↗](#) This page was last reviewed on March 31, 2022.

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